



ShabbaTTogether

Inherent Worth Program

“Like one being, with one heart.” Rashi (Shemot, 19:2)

Goals:

Goals for shluchim:

1. To create an environment of support and belonging in your community.
2. To be a proactive leader regarding mental health in your community using the teachings of chassidus to help lay a foundation of support and meaning for community members.

Goals for Teens and Young Adults are:

1. To gain an understanding of inherent worth and value from the teachings of chassidus as the starting point for self-worth and perspective on personal mental wellness and self-care.
2. To feel supported and that they belong without stigma or judgment in their community.

Target Audience:

Teen and Young Adults

Time:

1 hour

Medium:

In-person or Virtual. For **virtual**, please see below in red.

Note to Facilitator:

As the pandemic wears on, ongoing and necessary public health measures expose many people to experiencing situations linked to poor mental health outcomes, such as isolation.

Stress, panic attacks, depression, mood disorders and more are impacting up to 40% of the population. With much public discussion about suicide prevention and addiction among young adults, the time is right to address these topics from a Jewish perspective.

This program will provide:

1. Dvar Torah outline
2. Interactive activity and printable materials
3. Discussion prompts
4. Wrap-up questions

Dvar Torah Outline

- In the moments before the Jews received the Torah, becoming a nation over 3,000 years ago, the Torah refers to the Jews as a single entity.
- From the story in the Torah about Matan Torah: The Torah stops referring to the Jews as "they," and instead it is written, "and he camped."
- Rashi's question is why are all of the people suddenly referred to as one person?
- Rashi writes that they were "as one being, with one heart." One being? The Jews, Rashi explains, were so united in their purpose, they were like one entity.
- Similar to our bodies, we have one being with one heart. But that being is made up of many parts and structures with unique and important functions; the eyes see, the heart pumps blood, the kidney cleans the blood, the spine holds the body upright, the brain is the control center, and so on.
- We are one nation, and within that nation, each person has a unique and important function, and Hashem created each person with the exact strengths, challenges and circumstances to fulfill that function.
- There are 600,000 letters in the Torah, and the Jewish nation is comprised of 600,000 souls. The Torah and the Jewish nation share a spiritual connection.
- If one letter of the Torah is missing or has a mistake, the entire Torah scroll is passul.
- So, too, if one Jew is in pain, is struggling, or is not included, The Jewish nation is not complete and we are all affected.
- Additionally, each person is a mashpia and a mekabel - each soul has something to give and something to receive from another. We are each needed and are integral to the makeup of the unit.
- Each of us are our own unique puzzle piece that gives and receives from those around it, and together we make up the beautiful nation of the Jewish People.
- Just as it is a mitzvah to help someone, it is a mitzvah to reach out for help when you need it.
- To be a giver to someone else, you must have healthy mental wellness and healthy boundaries. Mental Wellness is a precursor to being a mashpia, a giver.
- Everyone likes to be on the giving end, however, as we all know, in truth it is a circle. Each of us has times when we give, and when we receive. Both are part of the mitzvah and both are part of being an individual soul in our collective nation.

Interactive Discussion Expectations

- Note: For all discussions and activities and to create a safe and welcoming environment, sharing expectations surrounding supportive discussion can help everyone feel comfortable sharing and set the tone.

Expectations

1. The details that are shared here stay here. General information of course can be shared. For example: What you liked about this, learned from it, etc.
2. Be aware of language. Do not use stereotypes or use demeaning language.
3. Ask and encourage questions!
4. Always assume the best and most genuine intention of others.
5. No interrupting.
6. If you feel like you need a break, feel free to excuse yourself and come back when you have regrouped.
7. If you notice that you're the person who is doing the most talking, give someone else a chance to join the conversation.
8. Ask the group: "What else are we missing?"

Interactive Activities

I. Which part of the puzzle are you?

Engage participants in a puzzle building activity and small group conversation to support the concept that in spite of necessary quarantines and isolation we are all connected, valuable, and that each person is necessary for the whole picture.

Materials for In-Person:

- *Cards with adjectives* written on them. [Click here to download](#) and print.
- Alternative: Buy a blank puzzle and write one adjective on each puzzle piece. Continue with activity, and at the end of the activity have everyone put the puzzle together.

Directions for In-Person:

1. Gather everyone in a circle (social distanced), and have adjective cards cut out in a pile on the floor in the middle of the circle. For larger groups, divide everyone into smaller groups of 5-7 people.
2. Everyone chooses two or three cards that they feel describes them.
3. Everyone discusses their choices.

4. After the discussion, you can have everyone put the cards together to create a shape, for example make them into a circle, a line, or just have them all together in a square. If using puzzle pieces, assemble the puzzle.

Directions for Virtual Adaptation:

1. Facilitators can screen share this image and participants can play this puzzle online at: <https://thewordsearch.com/puzzle/1794403/who-am-i/> or you can print and send to them in advance of the program.
2. Participants choose 2 to 3 words from the list that describe how they feel.
3. Everyone takes a turn discussing their choices.
4. After everyone takes their turn, the facilitator can ask participants to describe how they felt about the activity."

II. Discussion Prompts - Chochma, Bina, & Da'at

Materials for In-Person and Virtual:

- *Discussion Prompt Place Cards:*
 - Color: [Click HERE](#) to download and print in color (yellow, green & lilac).
 - B&W: [Click HERE](#) to download and print in B&W.

Setting the Tone: (During the pandemic, please practice social distancing)

1. Introduce the discussion:
 - a. We each have our thoughts, our paradigm, about who we are. Today we will challenge those thoughts and have the opportunity to build new self perceptions.
 - b. The process begins with the flash of an idea - we have prompts for exploring your self perception. This is like the process of **Chochmah**, Wisdom.
 - c. We will then turn to **Binah**, understanding. We will round out our first ideas with examples and deeper discussions.
 - d. Finally, we will have processed the ideas enough to discuss how to implement them. This is **Da'at**, Knowledge. Knowledge is when a person really comprehends the initial thought and then details, and is able to apply it to their own situation or circumstance.
2. Use the **yellow** cards first, then the **green**, and then the **purple**. The discussion elicits a progression and expansion of ideas and then their application.

In-Person Directions:

1. Place a discussion prompt placard at every seat or around a Shabbat dinner table.
(During the pandemic, please practice social distancing)

2. Use Dvar Torah Outline above to set the tone.
3. Activity options:
 - a. Ask each person to turn to the friend next to them and take turns discussing their prompts. Can then go around and ask each person to share their friend's remarks out loud - only with permission.
 - b. Ask everyone "who would like to share their prompt with us" and have students self-select to share.
 - c. Have everyone discuss their prompts in small groups away from the table over dessert and when they come back, ask who wants to share.

Directions for Virtual Adaptation:

1. Be prepared to set up break out rooms in Zoom.
2. Use the Dvar Torah Outline above to set the tone.
3. Facilitators can screen share for Chochma, Bina, & Da'at - Discussion Prompt Place Cards.
4. View the discussion prompts as a group and have a short discussion using the **above** in-person directions to **set the tone**.
5. Go into breakout rooms of 2 to 3 people. Discuss the prompts for 5 minutes.
6. Bring everyone back to the main room.
7. Ask everyone "who would like to share their prompt with us?" and have students self-select to share.

Wrap-up:

- Dvar Torah above or a short message promoting inherent worth, self value, and that each person is necessary for the whole community.
- Address the ongoing pandemic, what isolation can feel like when we aren't connected, and hope for the future.
- Ask: "What is something you learned about yourself during this discussion?"
- Ask: "What is one big takeaway you have to help you embrace your strengths?"

Handouts and Resources:

- Print resources before shabbat that you can leave out so people can see they are not alone and where to go for help - see below for options.
- Virtual: Share the links to these documents with the participants.
- Click links below to print or copy links to share with participants.
 - [What You Can Do](#)
 - [Some Facts on Mental Health](#)
 - [Mental Health Resources - non-editable](#)

- Edit this [Mental Health RESOURCE CARD](#) to add your local resources your community members can use if needed.